COLLECTIVE SECURITY

Balance of power, as a method of crisis management, is a lesser used method, and a modern device of collective action by international community, has become a more viable option. **Collective security**, as it is popularly known, has become a device that seeks to confront the would-be aggressors or aggressors with concerted power of states, determined to keep peace. Collective security, though at a glance might seem simplistic and self-explanatory, is difficult to define.

As Quincy Wright (1942) observed: “The relations of the balance of power to collective security have…been at the same time complementary and antagonistic”. It is not antithetic but supplementary and “International organization to promote collective security is … only a planned development of the natural tendency of balance of power policies”, and, again, the basic assumptions of the two are different. The substance of collective security is the creation of a world front against a possible aggressor and that of balance of power is to approximately equal the opposing fronts. But collective security involves a far greater degree of systematization than balance of power. As Inis Claude observed: “Balance of power is a system only by courtesy; while the accusation that it amounts to anarchy is too strong, it is assuredly a most unsystematic system … Collective security, on the other hand, represents the urge for systematization, the institutionalization of international relations”.[20]

Collective security is based on the principle that “Aggression against any one member of the international community is an aggression against international peace and security. As such it has to be met by collective efforts of all the nations”. It stands for “One for All and All for One”.

An effective collective security system should be strong enough and capable to meet any aggression from any power or combination of powers invoked as soon as aggression occurs. George Schwarzenberger‡ (an eminent scholar on power politics) observed collective security as a “machinery for joint action in order to prevent or counter any attack against an established international order”.